



Helicopter PARENTS

As parents, it is perfectly natural to want to advocate for and protect your child. But how far is too far?

| By Nandini Narayanan & Sharmi Ghosh Dastidar |

He was always told, repeatedly, by his parents that he was not the typical 12-year-old. He was meant to do bigger, better things in life. So while his friends went to school, played cricket, hung out with other friends and chatted online, his life revolved around a seemingly endless cycle of extra classes—English, science, math, history, geography, guitar, football, swimming, chess. He was an overachiever, no doubt, but was also terribly lonely and unhappy. The milestones of his life were being plotted so inexorably by his parents that one day, pushed into a crushing corner, he had no choice but to declare war with the world. He said “No” to everything, fought over every suggestion, rejected all coaching classes and, one day, stopped going to school. Finally, he was taken, kicking and screaming, to a psychologist.

Meet the classic victim of what educationists and media across the world are calling ‘helicopter parenting’. Closely involved in their child’s life, and named so because they are constantly hovering over the child,

LAWNMOWER: Will mow over everyone in their path until they get positional advantage for their precious offspring.

TOXIC: Those who meddle intrusively, in ways that imply the child is untrustworthy or ill-equipped to handle situations.